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AUGUST 22, 1938
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. JJ-S-566
Dec. 5, 1933

FEDERAL STANDARD STOCK CATALOG

Section IV

(Part 5)

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FOR

SOCKS; COTTON

This specification was approved on the above date by the Director of Procurement, for the use of all departments and establishments of the Government, and shall become effective not later than March 15, 1939. It may be put into effect, however, at any earlier date after promulgation.

A. APPLICABLE FEDERAL SPECIFICATIONS.

A–1. The following Federal Specifications of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall form a part of this specification:

JJ–H–601. Hosiery; Measuring-Sizes.
CCC–T–191. Textiles; Test Methods.

B. CLASSES AND GRADE.

B–1. *Classes.*—Socks, cotton, shall be of the following classes as specified:

Class A.—Medium weight, unbleached, bleached, or in colors.
Class B.—Mercerized, bleached, or in colors.
Class C.—Mercerized, light weight, bleached, or in colors.
Class D.—Heavy weight, mixed colors.

B–2. *Grade.*—Shall be of first quality.

C. MATERIAL AND WORKMANSHIP.

C–1. *Material.*—Shall be as follows:

C–1a. Classes A, B, C, and D shall be made from cotton not lower than "Middling" grade. The cotton shall be thoroughly carded and combed for classes A, B, and C and shall be thoroughly carded for class D.

C–1b. The yarns for classes B and C shall be well mercerized, gassed or not gassed, as specified in the invitation for bids. The heel and toe yarn will be either mercerized or unmercerized as specified in the invitation for bids.

C–1c. The average single end breaking strength of ungassed yarns found on 20 tests for 24/1, 36/2, 40/2, 50/2, 60/1, and 60/2 yarns in the

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undyed state as received from the spinner shall be not less than that shown in the following table:

24/1 Combed cotton yarn—245 grams (0.54 lb.), 15 turns per inch.
36/2 Combed, mercerized yarn—685 grams (1.50 lbs.), 14 turns per inch.
40/2 Combed cotton yarn—450 grams (0.99 lb.), 14 turns per inch.
50/2 Combed cotton yarn—380 grams (0.84 lb.), 15 turns per inch.
40/2 Mercerized cotton yarn—567 grams (1.25 lbs.), 14 turns per inch.
50/2 Mercerized cotton yarn—483 grams (1.06 lbs.), 15 turns per inch.
60/1 Combed mercerized yarn—135 grams (0.30 lbs.), 24 turns per inch.
60/2 Mercerized cotton yarn—395 grams (0.87 lb.), 16 turns per inch.

NOTE.—A tolerance of plus or minus 1 turn per inch will be allowed.

If the yarn to be tested for breaking strength is taken from the finished sock, a deduction of 15 percent from the requirements for the yarn in the natural state is allowed to compensate for the effects of knitting and dyeing. The average twist shall be that shown in the table.

C–1d. *Looping yarn.*—Shall be as shown in table I.

C–2. *Workmanship.*—The finished socks shall be clean, well shaped, well finished, free from holes, mends, and other imperfections and defects affecting appearance and/or serviceability.

D. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS.

D–1. *Construction.*—

D–1a. *Method.*—Shall be seamless or circular knit.

D–1b. *Ribbed portion.*—Shall be joined to the leg, loop for loop, without seaming or sewing, allowing expansion to the full width of the fabric. Shall be a true rib and the top shall have a pronounced welt

D–1c. *Closing of the toe.*—The closing of the toe shall be elastic smooth and free from lumps, laps, or dog ears. The toe shall have a ½-inch advanced or ring splicing for classes A, B, and C. If a looping machine is used, it shall be a two needle looper using a thread of yarn in each needle.

D–2. *Dimensions.*—The socks shall be knit full so that they will finish to proper size and length without stretching during boarding.

D–2a. *Length of foot.*—The length of the foot is denoted by size, and each sock shall have the proper size stamped on the toe. A plus or minus ¼ inch tolerance is allowed.

D–2b. *Length of leg.*—From the extreme ribbed top to the lower edge of the heel shall measure 14 inches for sizes 10 and under, 14½ inches for sizes 10½ to 13, and 15½ inches for size 13½ and up. A tolerance of plus or minus ½ inch is allowed.

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F. METHODS OF SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TESTS.

F–1. *Sampling.*—A single bundle out of each lot of not more than 1,000 packages shall be taken as representative of each delivery.

F–2. *Physical tests.*—Chemical tests. Shall be conducted in accordance with the methods prescribed in Federal Specification CCC–T–191, Textiles; Test Methods.

G. PACKAGING, PACKING, AND MARKING FOR SHIPMENT.

G–1. *Packaging.*—Unless otherwise specified, socks, cotton, shall be put up in bundles of 12 pairs of one size only. Each pair shall be reversed, and each bundle tied at each end with cotton twine or tape and encircled with a wrapper band.

G–2. *Packing.*—Unless otherwise specified, the subject commodity shall be delivered in standard commercial containers, so constructed as to insure acceptance by common or other carriers, for safe transportation, at the lowest rate, to the point of delivery.

G–3. *Marking.*

G–3a. *Issue packages.*—The wrapper on each bundle shall be marked with the name of the contractor, the number of the contract, the date packed, and the size of the socks.

G–3b. *Shipping containers.*—Shall be marked with the name of the material, the size, class, and the quantity contained therein, as defined by the contract or order under which shipment is made, the name of the contractor, the number of the contract or order, and date packed.

H. REQUIREMENTS APPLICABLE TO INDIVIDUAL DEPARTMENTS.

H–1. The following departmental specifications of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids and the following departmental requirements shall form a part of this specification:

H–2. *Army.*—

H–2a. U. S. Army Specification 100–2, Standard Specifications for Marking Shipments.

H–2b. *Methods of sampling and inspection.*—

H–2b (1). *Contractor's inspection.*—The contractor shall inspect all finished socks for compliance with this specification prior to submitting them to the United States Government for final inspection.

H–2b (2). *Sampling.*—Samples of any materials, components, etc., not furnished by the United States Government, entering into the manufacture of the articles covered herein shall be selected from time to time by the Government inspector and carefully examined and tests made to determine if they are in accordance with this specification.

H–2b (3). *Inspection.*—Inspection may be made throughout the entire process of manufacture. The passing as satisfactory of any detail of construction or material shall not relieve the contractor of responsibility for faulty workmanship or material which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance. Final inspection of the finished articles shall be made either at point of production or at point of delivery designated in the contract or purchase order of procuring agency. In case of factory inspection, every facility shall be afforded inspectors, by the manufacturer, for the prosecution of their work.

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H–2b (4). The requirements contained in paragraph C–1c of this specification shall not apply to U. S. Army purchases, unless so specified in invitation for bids.

H–2c. *Marking.*—Shipments shall be marked in accordance with U. S. Army Specification 100–2.

H–2d. *Note.*—The use of this specification for the grade of article covered herein is mandatory on all procuring agencies of the Army.

H–3. *Navy.*—

H–3a. Navy Department General Specifications for Inspection of Material, copies of which may be obtained without cost upon application to the Bureau of Supplies and Accounts, Navy Department, Washington, D. C.

H–3b. *Standard sample.*—In all respects not specifically covered by this specification, the socks shall be equal to standard sample, which may be obtained upon application to the Officer-in-Charge, Naval Clothing Depot, Brooklyn, N. Y.

H–3c. *Inspection.*—When tested in conformity with paragraphs D–4a and F–2 of this specification, socks shall show a degree of fastness of color equal to that of standard sample under similar conditions.

H–4. *Interior Department.*—The colors required are to be specified on contract, or are to match such samples as may be submitted by this department.

H–5. *Marine Corps—Standard sample.*—In all respects not covered by this specification, deliveries shall be equal to the standard sample, which may be obtained upon application to the Depot Quartermaster, U. S. Marine Corps, Philadelphia, Pa.

H–6. *Departments and establishments using classes herein designated:*

Army	Class A, unbleached; classes B and C, black or specified shades, mercerized.
Coast Guard	Class B, black, mercerized.
Interior	Class A, black, brown, and tan; Class D, mixed shades.
Marine Corps	Class A, natural white (unbleached).
Navy	Class B, black, mercerized.
Procurement Div., Treasury Dept. (General Schedule of Supplies).	Class A, white; Classes B and C, black, white, or colors; mercerized; Class D mixed shades, blue and white or brown and white.

I. NOTES.

I–1. Purchasers should exercise all options offered herein and should specify the class, size, and color required. (See pars. B–1 and D–4.)

I–2. It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all

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D2–c. *Length of ribbed portion.*—Shall measure 5½ inches with a tolerance of plus or minus ¼ inch.

D–3. *Elasticity.*—A loose elastic stitch shall be used so that the finished socks shall have good elasticity and be capable of being stretched with a slight amount of tension to widths, measured across the foot at a point midway between the toe and the heel, of not less than 6 inches for sizes 10½ and under and not less than 6½ inches for sizes over 10½.

D–4. *Colors.*—

D–4a. *Black.*—When black socks are specified, the color shall be obtained with a diazotized and developed direct dye, and shall be of good fastness to washing, crocking, and perspiration.

D–4b. *Solid colors other than black.*—The color shall be as specified in the invitation for bids, and shall have good fastness to washing, crocking, and perspiration. When vat dyeing is specified, the color shall show in addition, good fastness when subjected to tests for Fastness to Alkali and Fastness to Bleaching.

D–4c. *Mixed colors.*—The color mixture shall be as specified in contract or order. It shall be composed of dyed stock mixed with undyed cotton. Color shall have good fastness to washing, crocking, and perspiration.

D–4d. *Unbleached.*—The finished sock shall be a natural color, neither dyed nor bleached, but must be thoroughly scoured.

D–4e. *White.*—Shall be fully bleached.

D–5. *Finish.*—Socks shall be finished clean, free from loose ends, and properly boarded.

D–6. *Pairing.*—Each pair shall be secured at the top by tacking or by the use of nonrusting staple, unless otherwise specified in the invitation to bid.

D–7. *Length of ends.*—Length of ends shall be such that ends will not pull out when material is stretched to the limit.

E. DETAIL REQUIREMENTS.

E–1. *Construction.*—Shall conform to table I.

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TABLE I

	Class A	Class B	Class C	Class D
Number of courses per inch (minimum).	26 [1]	30 [1]	30 [1]	16.
Diameter of machine, inches.	3½ up to size 10½; 3½ or 3¾ size 11 up.[1]	3½ up to size 10½; 3½ or 3¾ size 11 up.[1]	3½ up to size 10½; 3½ or 3¾ size 11 up.[1]	4.
Needles per machine (minimum).	176 [1]	200 [1]	220 [1]	84.
Needles for gore of heal and toe, (minimum), (each side).	24	28	30	
Yarns (tolerance for size plus or minus 5%)[2]				
Heel and toe	2 ends 24/1 combed.[1]	1 end 40/2; 1 end 50/2 combed.[1]	2 ends 60/2 combed, mercerized.[1]	Mixed carded.
Leg and foot	do	1 end 40/2 combed, mercerized.	1 end 60/2 combed, mercerized.	Do.
Looping yarn [3]			2 ends 90/3 mercerized.	
Reinforcing: Heel and toe.	1 end 30/1 combed.			1 end 20/1 carded.
Sole and high splicing.		1 end 60/1 mercerized.	1 end 60/1 combed, mercerized.	
Rib	2 ends 24/1 combed.	1 end 36/2 combed, mercerized.[1]	1 end 40/2 combed, mercerized.	
Heel		High spliced, 1 end 60/1 combed, mercerized.	High spliced, 1 end 60/1 combed, mercerized.	
Sole		Reinforced 1 end 60/1 combed, mercerized.	Reinforced 1 end 60/1 combed, mercerized.	

WEIGHTS PER DOZEN IN OUNCES (MINIMUM)

(Weights based on size 11 for all classes.)

Size numbers:				
8	18	13¾	11¾	27½.
9	19	14¼	12¼	29.
9½	19½	14½	12¾	29¾.
10	20	15	13	30½.
10½	21	15¾	13¾	32.
11	21½	16	14	32¾.
11½	22	16½	14¼	33½.
12	22½	16¾	14½	34¼.
12½	23	17¼	15	35.
13	23½	17½	15¼	35¾.

[1] Unless otherwise specified in invitation to bid.
[2] Minimum yarn counts specified. Finer yarns may be used.
[3] Looping yarns of fine strong cotton of suitable sizes shall be used for classes A, B, and D.

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other respects. Standard samples may be inspected as provided in section H, under departmental requirements.

I–3. This specification covers only the types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodity as generally purchased by the Federal Government, and is not intended to include all of the types, etc., which are commercially available.

I–4. An index of Federal specifications may be purchased as noted in paragraph next below, price to be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.

I–5. Copies of this specification, and CCC–T–191 and JJ–H–601, may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order, or coupon, or cash, to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. Price 5 cents each.

Notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever, and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

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